

U.S. Trade Force — a one-page concept

Draft. Not sent, shared or published. My own idea, with no tie to any person, party or office.

What it is. U.S. Trade Force is my plan to make useful things here, close to the people who use them, and to get them the last few yards to the door.

The problem. A lot of what people need is made far away and shipped a long way. Big, bulky things cost more to ship than to make. And even when a thing gets close, it often fails in the last gap before it reaches a person. In the mountain West, that gap is the widest, because the towns are small and the miles are long.

Why the name fits now. President Trump's stated trade policy says it should put "American workers, manufacturers, farmers, ranchers, entrepreneurs, and businesses" first, and it calls for tools like tariffs and new one-on-one trade deals (White House, "America First Trade Policy" memo, Jan. 20, 2025). My plan is not about policy. It is about building things and moving things here.

Who it helps. People who make things in U.S. shops. Workers who want new skills. Schools, libraries and venues that buy what I make. And people in ten mountain-West states who live past the end of the line.

What I do first (small and real). I get one RIBBON table segment made by one U.S. shop, near where it will be used. I write down where every part comes from and what it cost to ship. That one sheet shows if "made near the buyer" works.

How my work feeds it.

- **RIBBON** (PRDs and business plan): my table system is built to be made in small shops near the buyer, from a file, so bulky freight stays low. It is the "make it here" piece.
- **Last Ten Yards** (post 1, twelve-episode plan, web store app): my plan for closing the last gap for people in ten mountain-West states. It is the "get it there" piece.
- **Depot brief:** a site I scouted in Salt Lake County with garages that could be a charge-and-dock home base. The roof, bays and power still need to be measured.
- **Armored drill books:** my study books for work tools. They can train the people who do the work.
- **Patent claims C1–C6:** my written ideas for parts like the docking latch, the seam caps and the service hub. None are filed yet.

The first 30 days.

- Week 1: Pick the one segment and draw up the parts list from my RIBBON PRDs.
- Week 2: Ask [number: Erik to set] U.S. shops for a quote. Measure the depot roof, bays and power.
- Week 3: Choose one shop. Write down the source of each part.
- Week 4: Get the segment made or get a firm date. Write one Last Ten Yards post on what I learned.

What I need. [amount: Erik to set] to build the first segment. [shop: Erik to pick] to make it. [place: Erik to pick] for the first test. [hours per week: Erik to set] of my own time. A patent lawyer's review before I file: [date: Erik to set].

Pinned: I want to own the sky.